Soubhagya Sahoo

S1007, Faculty of Economic Sciences
Higher School of Economics University,
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Academic Appointments

Assistant Professor [Dec 2023 – Present]
Department of Theoretical Economics, Faculty of Economic Sciences, HSE University, Moscow

Junior Fellow [Feb 2023 – Present]
Center for research on the Economics of Climate, Food, Energy and Environment (CECFEE), Indian Statistical Institute, Delhi Center

Visiting Assistant Professor [Feb 2023 – Nov 2023]
Center for research on the Economics of Climate, Food, Energy and Environment (CECFEE), Indian Statistical Institute, Delhi Center

Education

Ph.D., Economics [Aug 2017 – Jan 2023]
Department of Economic Sciences, Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur, India
Thesis: *Essays in Experimental Economics*

M.A., Economics [Aug 2015 – May 2017]
Center for Economic Studies and Planning, Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, India

B.Tech., Mining Engineering [Aug 2008 – Dec 2012]
Department of Mining Engineering, National Institute of Technology Rourkela, India

Research Interests

Major: Experimental Economics, Behavioral Economics.

Minor: Economic Development, Labor Economics, Applied Micro-Economics.

Publications

Journal Publications

1. "*Gender inequality and caste: Field experimental evidence from India*" with Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata), Asad Islam, Liang Choon Wang and Yves Zenou (Monash University). Journal of Economic Behaviour and Organization, 2021, vol 190, 111-124.

Working Papers

1. "*Informing the Job Search: A Field Experiment in an Urban Labor Market*" with Farzana Afridi (ISI Delhi) and Nikita Sangwan (Queen's University, Belfast).
2. "*Rights, Resilience and Self-Defense: Experimental Evidence on Pathways to Empowerment Among Adolescent Girls in India*" with Chitwan Lalji (IIM Kozhikode), Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata), Sarani Saha (IIT Kanpur), and Russell Smyth (Monash University). [*Under Review, Draft available on request*]
3. "*Smoke, Absence, and Chores: The Hidden Toll of Grandparental Loss on Indian Children*" with Arvind Mavliya (ISI Kolkata), Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata) and Dil B. Rahut (Asian Development Bank Institute, Tokyo). [*Under Review, Draft available on request*]

Work in Progress

1. "*Unintended consequences of Energy Subsidy: Evidence from India*" with Sarvesh Ingle (Ashoka University, Delhi NCR) and Sk Niyaj Mohammed (Shiv Nadar University, Delhi NCR).
2. "*Replacement or Autonomy? Parent-in-Law Death, Fertility Desires, and Maternal Well-Being in India*" with Arvind Mavliya (ISI Kolkata), Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata) and Dil B. Rahut (Asian Development Bank Institute, Tokyo).
3. "*Complementarities between Maternal Knowledge and Child Care Investment in Improving Child Health and Overall Development: Evidence from an Impact Evaluation in Indian Slums*" with Chitwan Lalji (IIM Kozhikode) and Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata).
4. "*Oil, War, and Rumour: Information Provision and Household Energy Insecurity During a Geopolitical Shock*" with Chitwan Lalji (IIM Kozhikode), Ngawang Dendup (Asian Development Bank Institute, Tokyo), Dil B. Rahut (Asian Development Bank Institute, Tokyo) and Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata).
5. "*Spirituality, Religiosity, and Locus of Control: Evidence from an endline survey on pathways to empowerment experiment among adolescent girls in India*" with Prasad Bhattacharya (Deakin University, Australia), Chitwan Lalji (IIM Kozhikode) and Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata).
6. "*Accidents do not happen, they are caused: Experimental evidence on the traffic situation in India*" with Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata) and Kaushiki Roy (ISI Kolkata).
7. "*Degrees over Dowry: Education as a Marriage Market Signal and Dowry Substitute in India*" with Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata), Kaushiki Roy (ISI Kolkata) and Arpita Kundu (ISI Kolkata).
8. "*When Should You Quit? A Field Experiment on Family Disclosure, Social Norms, and Willingness to Compete*" with Chitwan Lalji (IIM Kozhikode), Ngawang Dendup (ADBI, Tokyo), Dil B. Rahut (ADBI, Tokyo), Raja Rajendra Timilsina (ADBI, Tokyo) and Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata). [*In design phase*]
9. "*What Information Moves Willingness to Pay for Water Testing? Revealed Preference for Coliform, Chromium, and Lead Detection in Rural and Slum India*" with Chitwan Lalji (IIM Kozhikode), Ngawang Dendup (ADBI, Tokyo), Dil B. Rahut (ADBI, Tokyo), Raja Rajendra Timilsina (ADBI, Tokyo) and Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata). [*In design phase*]
10. "*AI-Based Legal Rights Awareness and Its Effects on Labour Force Participation, Financial Inclusion, and Confidence*" with Chitwan Lalji (IIM Kozhikode), Dil B. Rahut (ADBI, Tokyo), and Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata). [*In design phase*]

Opinion Pieces/Blogs/Media columns

1. "*Gender-caste intersectionality in discrimination: Do patients care about doctor's social identity?*" with Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata), Asad Islam, Liang Choon Wang and Yves Zenou (Monash University). **Ideas for India** [Publisher: International Growth Centre] (2021). [English] [Hindi]
2. "*Countering violence against women with awareness creation and self-defence training*" with Chitwan Lalji (IIM, Kozhikode), Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata), and Sarani Saha (IIT Kanpur). **Ideas for India** [Publisher: International Growth Centre] (2021). [English] [Hindi]

Conferences

1. Twentieth Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development (ACEGD) [2025]
   Indian Statistical Institute (Delhi) (Presented by co-author).
2. Advances with Field Experiments Conference [2025]
   University of Chicago (Presented by co-author).
3. Irish Economic Association Annual Conference 2025 [2025]
   Queen's University Belfast (Presented by co-author).
4. Wuhan University-HSE University Joint Workshop on Applied Economics [2025]
   Wuhan University, China.
5. Asian Meeting of the Econometric Society (AMES) [2023]
   Indian Institute of Technology Bombay.
6. Third Asian Workshop on Econometrics and Health Economics (AWEHE) [2022]
   Miyagi, Japan.
7. Winter School 2022 [2022]
   Delhi School of Economics, New Delhi.
8. Behavioral Research in Economics Workshop - Economic Science Association (BREW-ESA) [2022]
   Indian Institute of Management Bangalore, India.

9. Seventeenth Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development (ACEGD) [2022]
   Indian Statistical Institute New Delhi.

Professional Experience

Teaching

Instructor, Faculty of Economic Sciences, HSE University, Moscow

- Behavioral Economics, *Undergraduate*. 2024, 2025, 2026.
- Behavioral Economics, *Graduate*. 2025, 2026 (4.73/5).
- Experimental Economics, *Graduate*. 2024, 2025 (4.49/5), 2026 (4.54/5).

Teaching Ratings:

Academic Year	*Personal GPA*
2025/2026	4.44/5
2024/2025	4.19/5
2023/2024	4.04/5

The Behavioral Economics course for Master's students in the 2025/2026 academic year received the following accolades from the University course page: *Best Course for Career Development*, *Best Course for Broadening Horizons and Diversity of Knowledge and Skills* and *Best Course for New Knowledge and Skills*.

Tutor, Department of Economic Sciences, IIT Kanpur

- Introduction to Economics (ECO101A), *Undergraduate*.
  Summer 2019, First Semester 2019, Summer 2021, First Semester 2021.
- Microeconomics: Theory & Applications, *Online Certification Course by NPTEL*.
  January-April 2020 & 2021.

Teaching Assistant, Department of Economic Sciences, IIT Kanpur

- Microeconomics I (ECO201A), *Undergraduate*, First Semester 2020.
- Development Economics (ECO311A), *Undergraduate*, Second Semester 2020, Second Semester 2021, Summer 2021, Second Semester 2022.
- Behavioral & Experimental Economics (ECO506A), *Undergraduate*, Summer 2021.
  Development Economics (ECO735A), *Graduate*, Second Semester 2021.

Supervision

1. Baatiekuu Enoch Naanyaan (Master's) [2024-2026]
   Thesis: The Daughter Effect: How Does the Birth of a Girl Affect the Empowerment and Agency of Mothers in India
2. Nikolai Sapega (Master's) [2025-2026]
   Thesis: Justice Sensitivity as a Moderator of Reciprocity in Two-Stage Games

Fellowship and Grants

1. ADBI Grant ($10,000) for Research Project (Co-PI): "Informal Economy, Aspiration for Higher Income Status, and Quality Growth: Implication for the Bottom Billions" [2026]
   Asian Development Bank Institute (ADBI), Tokyo
2. ADBI Grant ($3,000) for Research Project (PI): "Cost Pass-Through of Iran War Oil Supply Shock (Implication on Asia's Prosperity with Quality Growth)" [2026]
   Asian Development Bank Institute (ADBI), Tokyo
3. ADBI Grant ($10,000) for Research Project (Co-PI): "Know your rights with AI" [2026]
   Asian Development Bank Institute (ADBI), Tokyo
4. ADBI Grant ($10,000) for Research Project (PI): "Revealed Preference for Water Quality Infrastructure in Rural and Urban Slum India" [2026]
   Asian Development Bank Institute (ADBI), Tokyo
5. RGHI Innovation Grant ($106,000) for Research Project (Co-PI): "Sustainability of hygiene behaviours in Indian slums" [2024]
   Reckitt Global Hygiene Institute, New Jersey

6. National Conference Travel Grant, IIT Kanpur [2023]
7. 17th Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development Travel Grant, ISI Delhi [2022]
8. National Conference Travel Grant, IIT Kanpur [2022]
9. Behavioral Research in Economics Workshop Travel Grant, IIM Bangalore [2022]
10. International Conference Travel Grant, IIT Kanpur [2022]
11. Asian Workshop on Econometrics and Health Economics (Japan) Conference Travel Grant [2022]
12. Doctoral Fellowship (SRF), IIT Kanpur [2019-22]
13. Doctoral Fellowship (JRF), IIT Kanpur [2017-19]

Software Skills

STATA, Python (Basic), MS-Excel, LaTeX.

Personal Information

Birth date: 15 January 1990
Nationality: Indian
Gender: Male
Marital status: Married
Languages: English (proficient), Odia (native), Hindi (fluent)

Reference

Available on Request.

Moscow - Russia, October 24, 2026